

# Paradiem

## The Morning Brief

AUGUST 6, 2026

### Metals Bid

*Gold and silver advance roughly 4% each as Hormuz stays unresolved; AMD fades, NVDA diverges from the semi complex.*

|                 |                 |                 |                 |                  |
|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|------------------|
| S&P 500         | NASDAQ          | GOLD (GLD)      | AMD             | FEAR & GREED     |
| \$769.79 ↓0.20% | \$717.30 ↓0.90% | \$389.64 ↑4.14% | \$482.05 ↓7.04% | 60 · Greed (CNN) |

## SECTION 01

### Markets — A Split Tape

#### SEMI FADE, WITH ONE EXCEPTION

The Tuesday semi rally reversed cleanly on Wednesday. AMD closed ↓7.04% at \$482.05, giving back most of its Tuesday advance as the after-hours margin and capex reaction extended into the regular session. CRDO ↓5.59%, MRVL ↓3.46%, LRCX ↓3.25%, QCOM ↓3.16%, and NXPI ↓2.71% all followed AMD lower. The exception matters: NVDA closed ↑3.43% at \$219.22 on the day AMD lost 7%. That divergence is the tape signaling that Wednesday's selling is a re-rating of merchant-silicon economics rather than a broad AI capex thesis reversal, and per Trading Key coverage, the fresh capital appears to be rotating into the perceived durable share-taker rather than the challenger.

|                    |                                             |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| GOLD (GLD)         | \$389.64 · ↑4.14% · 7-week peak per Reuters |
| SILVER (SLV)       | \$56.07 · ↑4.14%                            |
| AGNICO EAGLE (AEM) | \$165.45 · ↑9.85% · top FCI mover           |
| DOW                | \$542.81 · ↑0.44% · fresh record close      |
| S&P 500            | \$769.79 · ↓0.20% · winning streak snapped  |
| NASDAQ             | \$717.30 · ↓0.90% · AMD / Alphabet drag     |
| AMD                | \$482.05 · ↓7.04%                           |
| NVDA               | \$219.22 · ↑3.43% · diverged from complex   |

#### GOLD AND SILVER ADVANCE SHARPLY

Gold (GLD) and silver (SLV) both closed ↑4.14% Wednesday, with Reuters coverage flagging a seven-week peak in the metal as market participants weighed the ongoing Hormuz negotiation without a signed agreement. The move flowed cleanly into AEM ↑9.85% at \$165.45, the top FCI mover on the

session. Freeport-McMoRan (FCX) added ↑3.11% at \$69.39 on the accompanying copper-and-industrial-metals bid, extending a multi-week trend flagged by Yahoo Finance coverage of copper ETF inflows. A four-percent single-session move in both gold and silver on a day when equities were mixed and oil was near-flat is consistent with a safe-haven bid tied to unresolved geopolitical positioning, and the AEM leadership within the FCI growth sleeve reflects that channel.

#### ALPHABET'S TWO SIGNALS

The Nasdaq's ↓0.90% Wednesday session absorbed two distinct Alphabet stories per Yahoo Finance and Trading Union coverage: the raised 2026 capex range to \$195B–\$205B (from \$180B–\$190B) and the reported departure of Chief Scientist Jeff Dean alongside foundational AI researchers to launch an independent venture. FCI holds no direct GOOGL exposure, but the read-through matters for ServiceNow

(NOW ↓0.78% at \$117.22) via the software-margins-versus-AI-cost lens flagged in Bloomberg's Figma commentary, and for the utility-AI-power complex (VST ↓1.85%, CEG ↓0.80%, NEE ↓1.48%) if hyperscaler capex acceleration begins to price incremental load-growth durability more aggressively. Comm Services (XLC) closed ↓1.04% with Alphabet the dominant weight.

#### THE RATE BACKDROP

TLT closed ↑0.22% at \$83.00 as the July ISM Services PMI printed 54.1 against a 54.5 consensus per Bloomberg / ISM

coverage, with the Business Activity Index accelerating to 59.1 but the Employment Index falling back into contraction at 47.4. The mixed composition — expansion on activity, softness on hiring — kept the September FOMC firmly in the cut camp per CME FedWatch coverage. UVXY closed ↓4.83%, and the front-end responded more constructively than the equity tape suggested, particularly ahead of Friday's July nonfarm payrolls print per BLS schedule where consensus per Continuum Economics coverage centers near 80,000 versus June's 57,000, with the unemployment rate expected near 4.2%.

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*A safe-haven bid in gold alongside a semi fade is the tape asking a different question — what happens if the diplomatic window doesn't close on schedule. The physical world matters.*

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## SECTION 02

### Geopolitics — Hormuz Slips, Lebanon Flares

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#### THE IRAN-OMAN FRAMEWORK ADVANCES WITHOUT A SIGNATURE

Per CNBC and Washington Times coverage of the Wednesday sequence, Iran and Oman characterized the Strait of Hormuz talks as in their final stages. The proposed framework calls for commercial vessels to enter the Persian Gulf via an Iranian-controlled route and exit via an Oman-controlled route, with service fees charged for security and environmental preservation. President Trump reiterated per CNBC that a deal could materialize as early as Wednesday or Thursday, while an Iranian official denied direct US-Iran negotiations were underway per the same coverage — the same denial-confirmation choreography that has framed the last two weeks of price action. Crude priced through the sequence with WTI (USO) closing ↓0.78% at \$114.88 and Brent (BNO) ↑0.20% at \$45.41; the equity read was in the FCI energy sleeve, with CVX ↓2.10% at \$186.41, CNX ↓3.11% at \$34.54, and OKE ↓0.47% at \$87.24.

#### ISRAEL STRIKES SOUTH LEBANON

Per Reuters headlines captured in the data drop, Israel struck south Lebanon after Israeli soldiers were killed, with parallel diplomatic talks continuing in Rome. The escalation reopens a channel the market had largely priced as dormant through July and adds a second live theater to the existing Iran-Hormuz posture. The FCI defense sleeve traded softer despite the headline, with LMT ↓1.99% at \$577.60 and GD ↓0.44% at \$384.08 — a composition consistent with a market that continues to treat the primary catalyst as the Hormuz reopening rather than a broadening regional conflict. Should the Lebanon channel escalate materially, that asymmetry would likely reverse.

#### THE SINOPEC SIGNAL

Per Reuters exclusive reporting captured in the data drop, Sinopec stepped up Russian oil imports to offset Middle East supply cuts, according to traders and cargo trackers. The flow reroute is meaningful as a slow-moving signal on how the physical crude architecture is adapting to the current disruption sequence — incremental Russian barrels moving east ease the marginal-buyer pressure that would otherwise anchor the front-month bid. Combined with the OPEC+ September 188,000 bpd add-back and the pending Hormuz reopening scenario, the physical-crude setup continues to loosen at a pace that is not fully reflected in the front-month tape.

## On Our Radar

**1. CEG and MARA Report Today; ATO Beat.** Constellation Energy (CEG), a dividend-sleeve position, releases Q2 results today with consensus per data drop centering near \$2.45 EPS; CEG closed ↓0.80% at \$265.12 into the print alongside broader utility-AI weakness (XLU ↓1.02%). Marathon Digital (MARA) also reports today with consensus near \$0.19 per share, closing ↓4.34% at \$11.24 alongside HUT ↓8.30% in a punishing session for the mining cohort. Atmos Energy (ATO) delivered the FCI earnings beat Wednesday with Q3 EPS of \$1.43 versus the \$1.365 consensus per data drop, and per Yahoo / ChartMill coverage reaffirmed full-year guidance. The utility-AI thesis and Bitcoin-mining sleeve both face a live test today.

**2. Initial Jobless Claims — 8:30 AM ET.** The weekly initial jobless claims release lands this morning per DOL / ETA schedule, and per FRED historical framing the prior week's reading was in the low 220,000s. A material rise into the mid-230,000s would introduce a labor-softness vector one day ahead of the July nonfarm payrolls release Friday morning. A print in line with expectations keeps the Fed reaction function on track for a September cut, which market pricing per CME FedWatch coverage continues to treat as the base case.

**3. NFP and VST Set Up Friday.** The July nonfarm payrolls release lands Friday at 8:30 AM ET per BLS schedule with consensus per Continuum Economics near 80,000 (versus 57,000 in June) and the unemployment rate expected near 4.2%. Vistra (VST) reports Q2 pre-market Friday per StockTitan coverage with consensus per Barchart near \$2.43 EPS. VST closed ↓1.85% at \$140.58 into the print. The Friday morning setup delivers the labor read that dictates the Fed cut probability alongside the AI-power sleeve's primary earnings catalyst in a single hour — a materially concentrated event window into the weekend.

**4. Gold's Move and AEM Leadership.** Agnico Eagle Mines (AEM) closed ↑9.85% at \$165.45 as the top FCI mover on the day gold (GLD) and silver (SLV) both rose 4.14%. Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop, gold hit a seven-week peak as market participants weighed Hormuz reopening prospects, with Benzinga coverage flagging the metal-hoarding backdrop. For the FCI growth sleeve, AEM's single-session gain is a reminder that the precious-metals channel is functioning as an active portfolio hedge in the current geopolitical composition; the copper channel via FCX ↑3.11% provides a parallel industrial-metals read consistent with the broader theme.

**5. AMD Contamination Test — NVDA Held.** Wednesday delivered a live test of whether AMD's margin story would contaminate the broader semi complex. NVDA's ↑3.43% close on a day AMD lost 7% is the affirmative signal that the market is treating this as an AMD-specific re-rating rather than a sector event. That said, MRVL ↓3.46%, CRDO ↓5.59%, LRCX ↓3.25%, and NXPI ↓2.71% all followed AMD lower. The bifurcation — NVDA up, everyone else down — is the market's current answer to who takes the hyperscaler wallet share in the current AI capex cycle. Continued NVDA relative strength through the balance of the week would validate the framework.

**6. Carson's SPY \$645.80 Support.** Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY support at \$645.80 remains untouched through Wednesday's \$769.51–\$776.85 intraday range and sits approximately 16% below the current tape. The support was set April 13 as a retracement target. No active resistance levels are on the book following the April 14 breakout of the \$691.90–\$693.20 major zone. With gold ripping, AMD fading, Alphabet under capex-driven pressure, Hormuz unresolved, Lebanon flaring, and NFP plus VST both due Friday morning, the pre-committed deployment discipline (70% of reserves at –25% drawdown, remaining 30% at –40%) remains the operative framework rather than reactive positioning against any single Wednesday-Thursday tape signal.

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